



Sports **ICC WORLD TWENTY20**

The Seven DEADLY SPINS

Riding high on their victory in the inaugural Twenty20 tournament and the IPL roller-coaster, Dhoni's boys ran into some serious cricket. This is why they lost it.

| By Sharda Ugra in London |

If the merrie folk of Nottingham, who watched India on its last stop in the World T20, could speak in one voice, it would probably belong to someone called the Old Trent Bridge regular.

And he just didn't get it. Quiet people, Indians, he said, ever so polite, but something just *happened* to them when they got near cricket. They could make a right noise, they could. Their team had made so much noise too, winning many things in many coun-

tries, cricket like a fireworks display.

For an old codger, he quite liked T20 actually, so thought he'd better take a look when India came visiting. They were the T20 champions, all flashy batting, fiery bowling (the spinners, too!), acrobatic fielders, not like the old days. But then, between booking a ticket and collecting it, India were suddenly gone. Taken apart by the West Indies and, blimey, England. How had that happened? Where had the champions gone?

It is hard to explain to the old boy, but whatever he's heard about India, whatever we've heard, are myths churned out by the PR folk to fit an image defined as: Young, Fearless, Aggressive, Guaranteed to Conquer World. Not the most apt descriptors for guys who only beat Bangladesh and Ireland. The Old Trent Bridge regular awaits an explanation. The story of India's T20 campaign, truth be told, is a morality—and cricketing—tale. It revolves around Seven Deadly Spins.